



FELDMANDAXON
PARTNERS INC.



BEHAVIOURAL INTERVIEWING

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AGENDA

What is an interview?

Essential preparation

Components of S.T.A.R. Story

S.T.A.R. Story Examples

Examples of Behavioural Questions



WHAT IS AN INTERVIEW?

The Interview – A Business Meeting

An interview is a two-way communication process, a business meeting between a candidate and an organization's representative(s), exploring fit between the abilities of the candidate and the needs of the company.



EXPERIENCE SO FAR

What has your interviewing experience been like so far?

WHAT IS BEHAVIOURAL INTERVIEWING?



Behaviour based interviewing focuses on experiences, behaviours, knowledge, skills and abilities that are job related



Questions that seek to determine your behaviour, in particular past behaviour

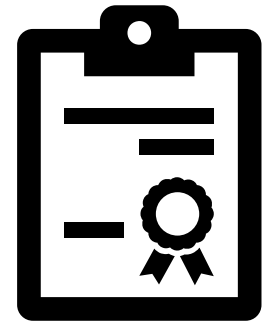


The answers you give about your past experiences will be used to predict your future performance

EVALUATION AND REFLECTION

Content Skills: Knowledge that is work specific such as computer programming, accounting

Functional or Transferable Skills: Skills which can be used in any role such as organizing, developing, communicating





ESSENTIAL PREPARATION

- Think like the employer – identify the skills and competencies likely to be required in the position you are seeking
- Analyze the job description
- Analyze your own background – what skills do have (content, functional) that relate to your job objective
- Identify examples from your past experience where you have demonstrated those skills and top behaviours

National Account Manager- Nestlé Professional Beverages Canada

Description

Nestlé was ranked the fifth most loved brand in the world in a survey of 70,000 consumers in 15 major international markets. Nestlé Canada was voted one of the best workplaces in Canada for three consecutive years and was also named one of Canada’s 10 Most Admired Corporate Cultures in 2013.

Major Responsibilities

- Review and evaluate National Account objectives and strategies and meet all placement growth targets.
- Build and maintain relationships with key customers in order to maximize sales and ensure proper execution of pricing and promotional programs
- Leverage NPB existing sales force to evaluate existing customer compliance, gain competitor information, and provide a valued source for new National Account opportunities.
- Grow Standard Beverage and Non-Dispensed Beverage business though assigned accounts
- Develop opportunities to drive consumption as well as to gain new profitable accounts
- Pursue opportunities that involve creation of custom label products
- Leverage key relationships within NPB distribution partners, NP Culinary, and the NPB U.S. National Accounts counterparts allowing for maximum exposure and networking
- Provide profit analysis templates to the National Account Leader on new business and existing contract renewals
- Resolve National Accounts concerns and issues
- Work with all sales, support and logistics employees internally to ensure maximum efficiency and results
- Grow margins, meet assigned targets and finance objectives on all new business opportunities
- Demonstrate commercial acumen and National Account brand awareness
- Manage the trade spend and placement of trade assets

Qualifications

- A university degree in Business or Marketing or equivalent combination of education and experience
- Strong working knowledge and experience in the Canadian Foodservice industry
- Minimum 5 years of progressive experience in sales and national account management
- Entrepreneurial spirit with the ability to leverage Nestlé processes, resources and environment.
- Ability to communicate internally and externally with multiple functions especially Executive level management, National Procurement and Planning Managers as well as Key Account Management.
- Strategic thinking with the ability to influence others
- Demonstrated project management, presentation and negotiating skills
- Self-motivated, results focused with strong analytical skills

Competencies, themes, trends required for this position to anticipate questions

WHY BEHAVIOURAL QUESTIONS?

1

Behavioral questions help determine if the candidate can prove that they have taken actions that have delivered results

2

Behavioral questions make the candidate recall actions and results they have experienced and described them in detail

3

Indication of the way you act, your method of operation and the way you handle situations

SPECIFIC QUESTIONING

Questioning requires a specific scenario:

- Tell me about a time when...
- Give me an example of a time when...
- Describe for me...

As opposed to a hypothetical scenario:

- “What would you do if...”

PREPARING A S.T.A.R. STORY



S **SITUATION**

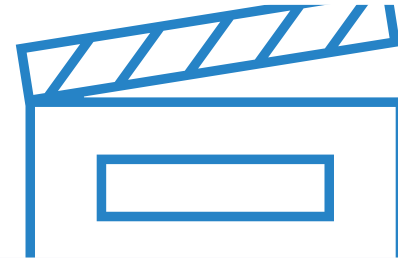
Describes the situation you were involved in

Puts the story into context



T **TASK**

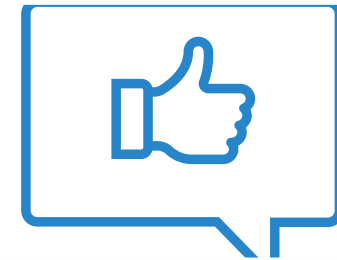
Describe what needs to be done



A **ACTION**

Elaborate on your specific actions

What exactly did YOU do?

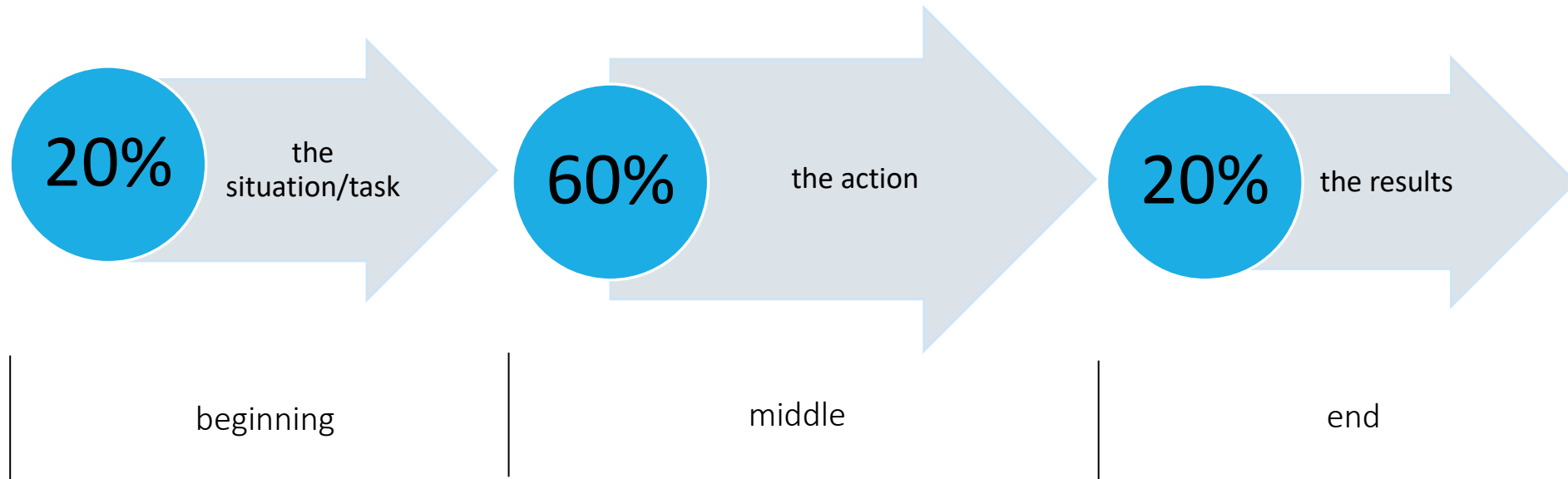


R **RESULT**

Describes the Result or outcome of your actions

State the benefits

PROPORTIONS OF A S.T.A.R. STORY



WHY S.T.A.R. STORIES?

- Listening is hard work. Stories convey clear examples that link the benefit of your skills to their needs
- Your stories are unique and differentiate you
- Stories reveal skills as well as your personality and communication style
- Stories contain specific details that hold interest
- **People think and remember in pictures**
- 1-3 minutes in length



S.T.A.R. STORY EXAMPLE

Tell me about a time you improved business performance?

- **Situation:** I was assigned as an account manager to take over an underperforming sales territory – #92 out of 100 districts.
- **Task:** To increase sales 20% and boost customer base 10%. Costs in the division were steadily rising, and I was asked to find ways to reduce them.
- **Action:** A market analysis and customer service survey was conducted; a business plan that focused on value-added service, sales incentives, and referral bonus program to benefit customers was developed; and 3-level marketing strategy was rolled out to implement the plan.
- **Result:** District ranking improved to #9 in the region; store sales increased 37%. My business plan was adapted for use by all account managers in the region. Earned Account Manager of the Year Award.

Revised: Tell me about a time you improved business performance?

- **Situation:** Recently promoted to Regional Director I was assigned by senior leadership to take over an underperforming sales territory which ranked #92 out of 100 districts.
- **Task:** To increase sales 20% and boost customer base 10%.
- **Action:** I conducted a market analysis including an assessment of competitive landscape. I collaborated with the marketing team to develop a new business program that focused on value-added service, sales incentives, and referral bonus system to both motivate the sales team and to boost customer base. I conducted an information session with sales team to communicate the marketing strategy prior to implementation.
- **Result:** Within a year, district ranking improved from #92 to 9 in the territory. Store sales increased 37% and customer base increased 15%. Due to the success of the program, it was adapted and implemented into all districts. I earned Account Manager of the Year Award.

Tell me about a time you demonstrated adaptability?

- **Situation:** I was working as project lead on a major marketing campaign for my company when by coincidence, two weeks before launch, a competitor launched a campaign that was very similar in content. Pushing ahead with our plans would have seemed like we were duplicating what our competitor launched, even though we had already been working on our campaign for weeks.
- **Task:** I was tasked with coming up with an alternative plan.
- **Action:** I knew we had to immediately change tactic, so I called an urgent meeting with my team and had a brainstorming session in which everyone provided input. I conducted additional research, and decided our goals would be left unchanged, but it was more about changing the look and feel of the content and coming up with a few fresh ideas. I mapped out a new plan with input from the team and assigned various team members to create the new content. I also enlisted the help of a freelancer who I knew would be able to produce quality content quickly.
- **Result:** With a large dose of hard work and collaboration we managed to launch on time and produce a very successful campaign that generated a 28% spike in leads. In the end the new content was even better than what we had originally planned, and I was very proud of the way my team and I were able to quickly pivot and deliver.



Tell me about a situation in which you had to collaborate with several people to achieve a goal.



Give me a specific example of a time when you convinced your manager of an idea?



Tell me about a time you provided excellent customer service.



Tell me about a time you had to deal with conflict within your team.



Tell me about a time when you missed an obvious solution to a problem.



Describe a time when you anticipated potential problems and developed preventive measures.

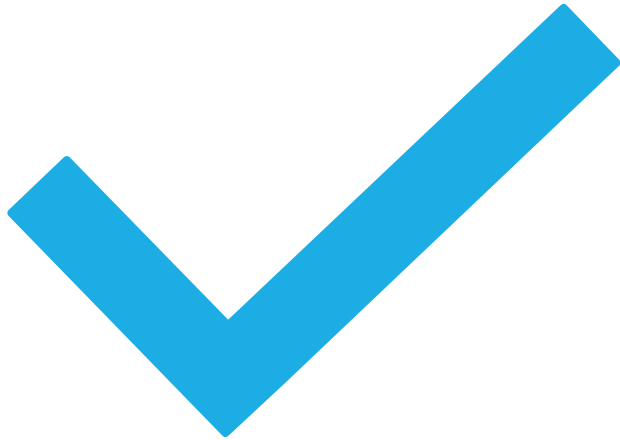
SAMPLE BEHAVIOURAL QUESTIONS



METHODS OF CONVEYING VALUE

- Linking your past successes and future solutions to employer's needs
- Demonstrating a return on investment (ROI)

RECAP TIPS



- Review the job posting
- Review major projects you have worked on
- Revisit previous performance reviews
- Use the STAR methods to structure your responses
- Make a chart to organize your stories
- Practice

STAR STORY SUMMARY SHEET

Name of Story	Highlights	Competencies
Story #1		
Story #1		
Story #1		



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Thank you for your time!

ANY QUESTIONS?

